

Word family: **proportion / proportions / proportioned / proportioning / proportional / proportionally / proportionality / proportionate / proportionately / disproportionate / disproportionately / disproportional / well-proportioned / ill-proportioned**

Base word: proportion

Part of speech: mainly **noun**, with a less common **verb** use

Related forms:

* **proportion** (n.) — 比例；部分；份額；相對大小；均衡；尺寸

* **proportion** (v.) — 按比例安排 / 分配；使各部分比例協調

* **proportional** (adj.) — 成比例的；比例上的；按比例

* **proportionally** (adv.) — 按比例地；相應地

* **proportionality** (n.) — 比例關係；相稱性；比例原則

* **proportionate** (adj.) — 相稱的；合乎比例的；與情況相稱的

* **proportionately** (adv.) — 相稱地；按比例地

* **disproportionate** (adj.) — 不成比例的；過度的；不相稱的

* **disproportionately** (adv.) — 不成比例地；過度地

* **disproportional** (adj.) — 不成比例的，較少見 / 較技術性

* **well-proportioned** (adj.) — 比例勻稱的；各部分協調的

* **ill-proportioned** (adj.) — 比例不協調的

Major useful extensions:

a proportion of, large/small/high/low proportion, significant/substantial proportion, growing/increasing proportion, proportion of customers, proportion who..., in proportion to, out of proportion to, direct proportion, inverse proportion, proportional to, directly proportional to, inversely proportional to, proportional increase/decrease, proportional share, proportional allocation, proportional representation, proportional response, proportionate response, proportionate measure, proportionate penalty, proportionate cost, proportionate to the risk, proportionate to the seriousness, principle of proportionality, proportionality test, disproportionate response, disproportionate impact, disproportionate burden, disproportionately affect, proportions of an object/body, human proportions, physical proportions, gigantic/epic/huge proportions, reach epidemic proportions, sense of proportion, keep things in proportion, lose all sense of proportion, blow something out of proportion, get something out of proportion, well-proportioned body/room/building, proportion ingredients/materials.

Meaning in this passage

> At issue is not whether customers should be allowed to change their minds without limit, but whether our present rule is **proportionate** for online fashion.

Here, **proportionate** means:

not more severe or restrictive than is reasonably justified by the situation — 相稱的；合乎比

例的；不過度的**

Chris is asking whether an absolute:

> **no-exchange / no-refund rule**

is too severe given that online customers:

- * cannot try clothes on,
- * cannot feel the fabric,
- * depend on size charts,
- * depend on accurate delivery,
- * may receive something defective or materially different.

So here:

proportionate = 規則的嚴格程度與它要處理的風險、問題和實際情況相稱

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 真正需要討論的，是我們目前的規定對網上時裝購物而言是否**合乎比例 / 是否過於嚴苛**。

A very useful paraphrase is:

> **Is the rule stricter than necessary?**

A. PROPORTION = A PART / SHARE OF A WHOLE

1. **a proportion of something = a part or share of the whole — 一部分；比例**

This is one of the two biggest everyday meanings.

Practice 1

> A large **proportion of customers** shop online.

很大**比例的顧客**在網上購物。

Practice 2

> Only a small proportion of returns involve defective goods.

只有一小**部分退貨**涉及有缺陷商品。

Practice 3

> A significant proportion of complaints concerned sizing.

相當大**比例的投訴**與尺碼有關。

MCQ-ready definition:

proportion = 一個整體中某一部分所佔的份額或比例

2. **a large/high proportion of — 大比例的；很大部分**

Practice 1

> A **large proportion of sales** now comes from online orders.

現在很大**部分銷售額**來自網上訂單。

Practice 2

> A high proportion of returned jeans had sizing issues.

很高**比例的退回牛仔褲**都有尺碼問題。

3. **a small/low proportion of — 小比例的**

Practice 1

> Only a **small proportion of customers** abuse the return system.

只有一小**部分顧客**濫用退貨制度。

Practice 2

> Defects account for a relatively low proportion of returns.

缺陷商品只佔退貨的相對較低**比例**。

4. **a significant proportion — 相當大 / 重要比例**

Practice 1

> A **significant proportion** of complaints could be avoided.

相當大**部分投訴**其實可以避免。

Practice 2

> Repeat customers generate a significant proportion of revenue.

回頭客帶來相當大**比例的收入**。

5. **a substantial proportion** — 相當大的比例

Practice 1

> A **substantial proportion** of online shoppers rely on size charts.

相當大**比例的網購顧客**依賴尺碼表。

Practice 2

> Returns represented a substantial proportion of warehouse work.

退貨佔倉庫工作量的**相當大部分**。

6. **a growing/increasing proportion** — 日益增加的比例

Practice 1

> A **growing proportion** of purchases are made online.

愈來愈大**比例的購物**在網上完成。

Practice 2

> An increasing proportion of customers expect flexible returns.

愈來愈高**比例的顧客**期望有彈性退貨安排。

7. **proportion of people who...** —的人所佔比例

Practice 1

> The **proportion of customers who returned an item** fell after the size guide improved.

改善尺碼指南後，**曾退貨的顧客比例**下降了。

Practice 2

> We should measure the proportion of complaints that result in refunds.

我們應量度最終導致退款的**投訴比例**。

B. PROPORTION VS PERCENTAGE

Important distinction 1: **proportion vs percentage**

proportion

part/share of a whole, which may be expressed in:

- * fraction,
- * decimal,
- * percentage,
- * ordinary wording.

percentage

specifically expresses the quantity **out of 100**.

Example:

- > 1/4 is the **proportion**
- > 25% is the **percentage**

So:

- > “a high proportion of customers”
- > does not require an exact percentage.

Important distinction 2: **proportion vs number**

Compare:

> 500 customers returned products.

= **number**

> 10% of customers returned products.

= **proportion**

If the total customer base changes, the number and proportion can move differently.

Important distinction 3: **proportion vs rate**

proportion

share of a defined whole.

rate

frequency/amount relative to another measure, often involving:

- * time,
- * opportunities,
- * population,
- * transactions.

For example:

> proportion of orders returned

> = returned orders ÷ all orders

> return rate

> may be defined similarly in retail, but **rate** is a broader statistical/business concept.

C. PROPORTION = RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN QUANTITIES

8. **proportion = comparative relationship between amounts — 比例關係**

Practice 1

> The ingredients must be mixed in the correct **proportions**.

配料必須按正確**比例**混合。

Practice 2

> The proportion of cost to revenue changed.

成本與收入之間的**比例關係**改變了。

MCQ-ready definition:

proportion = 兩個或以上數量之間的相對大小關係

9. **in the right/correct proportion — 比例正確**

Practice 1

> The ingredients were combined in the **correct proportions**.

各種材料按**正確比例**混合。

Practice 2

> Staff and workload need to be in the right proportion.

人手與工作量需要保持**合理比例**。

10. **relative proportions — 相對比例**

Practice 1

> The chart shows the **relative proportions** of refunds and exchanges.

圖表顯示退款和換貨的**相對比例**。

Practice 2

> The relative proportions changed during the pilot.

各類個案的**相對比例**在試行期內有所改變。

D. IN PROPORTION TO

11. **in proportion to something = corresponding appropriately to it — 與.....成比例 / 相稱**

A major construction.

Practice 1

> Costs should remain **in proportion to sales**.

成本應與銷售額保持**合理比例**。

Practice 2

> The response should be in proportion to the seriousness of the abuse.

處理方式應與濫用行為的嚴重程度**相稱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

in proportion to X = 大小、程度或嚴格程度與 X 有適當的比例關係

12. **increase in proportion to — 隨.....按比例增加**

Practice 1

> Warehouse costs may rise **in proportion to return volume**.

倉庫成本可能隨退貨量**按比例上升**。

Practice 2

> Staffing should increase roughly in proportion to workload.

人手應大致隨工作量**按比例增加**。

E. OUT OF PROPORTION TO

13. **out of proportion to something = too large/small relative to it — 與.....不成比例**

A major expression.

Practice 1

> The penalty seems **out of proportion to the mistake**.

處罰與錯誤程度**不成比例 / 過重**。

Practice 2

> The cost of processing the case was out of proportion to its value.

處理個案的成本與個案價值**不相稱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

out of proportion to X = 相對於 X 而言過大、過小或不合理

14. **completely out of proportion — 完全失去比例 / 嚴重不相稱**

Practice 1

> The reaction was completely **out of proportion**.

反應**完全過度了**。

Practice 2

> The restrictions were out of proportion to the actual risk.

限制措施與實際風險**嚴重不成比例**。

F. PROPORTIONATE = APPROPRIATELY MATCHED IN DEGREE

15. **proportionate = appropriate relative to another factor — 相稱的 ; 合乎比例的**

This is the exact passage branch.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Is our present rule **proportionate** for online fashion?

現行規定對網上時裝購物而言是否**合乎比例**？

Practice 2

> The response should be proportionate to the seriousness of the problem.

回應措施應與問題的嚴重程度**相稱**。

Practice 3

> Controls should be proportionate to the risk of abuse.

控制措施應與濫用風險**相稱**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proportionate = 程度、規模或嚴格程度不超過情況合理需要，而且與相關風險 / 問題相稱****

16. ****proportionate to the risk — 與風險相稱****

Practice 1

> Safeguards should be ****proportionate to the risk****.

保障措施應與風險**相稱**。

Practice 2

> A very low-risk case does not require disproportionately strict controls.

風險很低的個案不需要**過度嚴格的控制**。

17. ****proportionate to the seriousness — 與嚴重程度相稱****

Practice 1

> Any penalty should be ****proportionate to the seriousness of the abuse****.

任何處罰都應與濫用的嚴重程度**相稱**。

Practice 2

> Management should choose a proportionate response.

管理層應採取**程度相稱的回應**。

18. ****proportionate response — 適度 / 相稱的回應****

Practice 1

> A warning may be a ****proportionate response**** to a first minor breach.

對首次輕微違規而言，警告可能是****程度相稱的處理方式****。

Practice 2

> Permanent exclusion might not be proportionate in every case.

永久禁止某人使用服務在每個個案中未必都****合乎比例****。

19. ****proportionate measure — 相稱的措施****

Practice 1

> Inspection is a ****proportionate measure**** for higher-risk returns.

對高風險退貨而言，檢查是一項****相稱的措施****。

Practice 2

> Measures should remain necessary and proportionate.

措施應保持必要而且****不過度****。

20. ****proportionate penalty — 相稱的處罰****

Practice 1

> Penalties should be ****proportionate****.

處罰應該****合乎比例****。

Practice 2

> The penalty was not proportionate to the violation.

這項處罰與違規程度****不相稱****。

G. PROPORTIONAL VS PROPORTIONATE

Important distinction 4: **proportional vs proportionate**

These overlap but are **not identical**.

proportional

often mathematical/quantitative:

- > costs are proportional to sales
- > 成本與銷售額**成比例**

proportionate

often evaluative:

- > penalty is proportionate to offence
- > 處罰與違規程度**相稱** / **不過度**

For your passage:

proportionate is the better word

because the question is:

- > Is the rule **reasonably balanced relative to the situation?**

not:

- > Does it obey a mathematical ratio?

Important distinction 5: **proportional can also mean fairly allocated by share**

Example:

- > proportional allocation
- > 按比例分配
- > proportional representation
- > 比例代表制

Here it is quantitative, not about “being reasonable.”

H. PROPORTIONAL = CHANGING IN CORRESPONDING RATIO

21. **proportional to = changing according to a corresponding ratio — 與.....成比例**

Practice 1

> Processing cost may be roughly **proportional to the number of returns**.

處理成本可能大致與退貨數量**成比例**。

Practice 2

> The fee is proportional to the value of the order.

費用與訂單價值**成比例**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proportional to X = X 改變時，另一數量按相應比例改變

22. **directly proportional — 成正比**

Practice 1

> If two quantities increase in the same constant ratio, they are **directly proportional**.

如果兩個量以固定比例一起變化，它們便**成正比**。

Practice 2

> Cost is not necessarily directly proportional to sales volume.

成本並不一定與銷量**成正比**。

You covered **direct proportion** under **direct**, but it belongs strongly here too.

23. **inverse proportion / inversely proportional — 反比例 / 成反比**

Practice 1

> In a simple inverse relationship, one quantity rises as the other falls according to a fixed product.

在簡單的**反比例關係**中，一個量上升時，另一個量按相應關係下降。

Practice 2

> The variables are inversely proportional.

這些變量**成反比**。

24. **proportional increase — 按比例增加**

Practice 1

> Costs showed a **proportional increase**.

成本**按比例增加**。

Practice 2

> Higher order volume did not produce a proportional increase in complaints.

訂單量增加並沒有造成投訴量**同比例增加**。

25. **proportional decrease — 按比例下降**

Practice 1

> The discount resulted in a proportional decrease in revenue per item.

折扣令每件商品收入**按比例下降**。

Practice 2

> Return rates did not fall in proportion to the improvement in delivery accuracy.

退貨率並沒有隨送貨準確度改善而**同比例下降**。

26. ****proportionally — 按比例地****

Practice 1

> Smaller stores were affected ****proportionally more****.

較小型店舖按其規模而言受到****比例上更大的影響****。

Practice 2

> Costs should rise proportionally with workload.

成本應隨工作量****按比例上升****。

I. PROPORTIONAL SHARE / ALLOCATION

27. ****proportional share — 按比例計算的份額****

Practice 1

> Each department pays a ****proportional share**** of the cost.

每個部門按比例承擔其****相應份額****。

Practice 2

> Refund costs could be allocated according to each division's proportional share of sales.

退款成本可按照各事業部的銷售****比例份額****分配。

28. ****proportional allocation — 按比例分配****

Practice 1

> The company used ****proportional allocation**** to divide the budget.

公司採用****按比例分配****方式分配預算。

Practice 2

> Resources were allocated proportionally according to demand.

資源按照需求**按比例分配**。

J. PROPORTIONAL REPRESENTATION

29. **proportional representation — 比例代表制**

A fixed electoral-system term.

Practice 1

> **Proportional representation** allocates representation broadly according to vote shares under the relevant system.

比例代表制按照相關制度，以票數比例分配代表席位。

Practice 2

> There are several different forms of proportional representation.

比例代表制有多種不同形式。

MCQ-ready definition:

proportional representation = 讓政黨 / 名單所得代表席位與其獲得的選票比例較密切對應的選舉制度類型

This is a lexicalized political term; exact rules vary by electoral system.

K. PROPORTIONALITY

30. **proportionality = relationship of appropriate proportion — 比例關係；相稱性**

Practice 1

> The figures show rough **proportionality** between volume and cost.

數據顯示數量與成本之間大致存在**比例關係**。

Practice 2

> The debate concerns the proportionality of the restriction.

爭議涉及這項限制的**相稱性 / 是否過度**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proportionality = 兩個量成比例的關係，或某項措施與其目的 / 風險是否適當相稱的原則****

Notice the noun itself has both:

- * quantitative,
- * evaluative/legal

branches.

31. ****principle of proportionality — 比例原則****

A major legal/regulatory/ethical term.

Practice 1

> The ****principle of proportionality**** asks whether a measure goes further than is justified relative to its purpose.

****比例原則****會考慮一項措施相對於其目的而言是否過度。

Practice 2

> Restrictions should be necessary and proportionate.

限制措施應有必要，而且****符合比例原則****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****principle of proportionality = 採取的限制、處罰或措施應與所追求目的、風險或問題嚴重性合理相稱****

This is very close to the reasoning in your passage.

32. ****proportionality test — 比例性測試 / 比例原則審查****

Practice 1

> Legal systems may use forms of ****proportionality analysis**** when reviewing restrictions.

一些法律制度在審查限制措施時會運用某種****比例原則分析****。

Practice 2

> The exact test varies by legal context.

具體的**比例性測試**會因法律語境而異。

Important distinction 6: **proportionality vs fairness**

proportionality

asks whether the measure is appropriately matched to:

- * risk,
- * harm,
- * objective,
- * seriousness.

fairness

broader question of justice/equal treatment.

A policy can be criticized on both grounds, but they are not identical.

Important distinction 7: **proportionate vs necessary**

necessary

is the measure genuinely needed?

proportionate

even if needed, is its severity/scope appropriately limited?

For example:

> Some anti-abuse control may be necessary.

But:

> a total ban on all legitimate returns

may still be disproportionate.

This maps beautifully onto your passage.

L. DISPROPORTIONATE

33. **disproportionate** = too large/small relative to what is appropriate — 不成比例的；過度的

A major opposite.

Practice 1

> A complete ban may be a **disproportionate response** to limited abuse.

如果濫用情況有限，全面禁止可能是**過度的回應**。

Practice 2

> The rule places a disproportionate burden on genuine customers.

這項規則令真正顧客承擔**不成比例的負擔**。

MCQ-ready definition:

disproportionate = 相對於問題、風險或其他比較基準而言過大、過小或不合理

34. **disproportionate response** — 過度 / 不相稱的回應

Practice 1

> Refusing every refund could be a **disproportionate response** to the risk of misuse.

因為有濫用風險便拒絕所有退款，可能是**過度反應**。

Practice 2

> The penalty was disproportionate to the offence.

處罰與違規行為**不相稱**。

35. **disproportionate impact** — 不成比例的影響

Practice 1

> The policy may have a **disproportionate impact** on first-time customers.

政策可能對首次購買的顧客造成**不成比例的影響**。

Practice 2

> Small businesses may bear a disproportionate share of the cost.

小型企業可能承擔**不成比例的成本份額**。

36. **disproportionate burden — 過重 / 不成比例的負擔**

Practice 1

> The paperwork creates a **disproportionate burden** for minor exchanges.

對輕微換貨而言，相關文書工作造成**過度負擔**。

Practice 2

> Controls should not impose disproportionate burdens on honest customers.

控制措施不應令誠實顧客承擔**不合理地沉重的負擔**。

37. **disproportionate cost — 不成比例的成本**

Practice 1

> Manual review may create a disproportionate cost for very low-value items.

對價值很低的商品而言，人手審查可能造成**不成比例的成本**。

Practice 2

> A safeguard is not efficient if its cost is disproportionate to the risk.

如果保障措施的成本與風險**不相稱**，它便未必有效率。

M. DISPROPORTIONATELY

38. **disproportionately = to an excessive/unequal degree — 不成比例地；過度地**

Practice 1

> The rule may **disproportionately affect online shoppers**.

這項規則可能**不成比例地影響網購顧客**。

Practice 2

> A small number of customers account for a disproportionately large share of returns.

少數顧客佔了**不成比例地大的退貨份額**。

39. **disproportionately high/large — 高得 / 大得不成比例**

Practice 1

> Return rates are **disproportionately high** for one size.

其中一個尺碼的退貨率**高得不成比例**。

Practice 2

> One category generated a disproportionately large number of complaints.

某一類產品產生了**異常高比例的投訴**。

40. **disproportionately low/small — 低得 / 小得不成比例**

Practice 1

> The smallest stores received a disproportionately low share of support.

最小型店舖得到的支援**比例過低**。

Practice 2

> The refund amount was disproportionately small relative to the loss.

退款金額相對於損失而言**小得不相稱**。

N. PROPORTIONS = DIMENSIONS / RELATIVE SIZE OF PARTS

41. **proportions = relative dimensions of parts — 各部分比例；身形 / 尺寸比例**

A genuinely distinct plural noun branch.

Practice 1

> The dress was designed for different body **proportions**.

這條裙的設計適合不同的**身體比例**。

Practice 2

> The building has elegant proportions.

這幢建築物的**各部分比例十分優美協調**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proportions = 一個物體不同部分彼此之間的相對大小和尺寸關係****

42. **body proportions — 身體比例**

Particularly relevant to clothing.

Practice 1

> Two people with the same height may have different **body proportions**.

兩個身高相同的人可能有不同的**身體比例**。

Practice 2

> Standard size charts cannot perfectly reflect every body proportion.

標準尺碼表無法完美反映每個人的**身形比例**。

43. **human proportions — 人體比例**

Practice 1

> The artist studied **human proportions**.

藝術家研究**人體比例**。

Practice 2

> Fashion design often takes body proportions into account.

時裝設計常需要考慮**人體各部分比例**。

44. **proportions of a room/building** — 房間 / 建築的比例

Practice 1

> The room has pleasing **proportions**.

房間的**空間比例**很協調。

Practice 2

> Large windows changed the visual proportions of the building.

大型窗戶改變了建築物的**視覺比例**。

O. WELL-PROPORTIONED

45. **well-proportioned** = having attractive/balanced relative dimensions — 比例勻稱的

Practice 1

> The room is **well-proportioned**.

房間的**比例**很協調。

Practice 2

> The design creates a well-proportioned silhouette.

這個設計形成**比例勻稱的輪廓**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****well-proportioned = 不同部分的大小互相協調，看起來均衡****

46. ****well-proportioned body/figure — 身材比例勻稱****

Practice 1

> The garment was designed to create a ****well-proportioned silhouette****.

服裝設計旨在營造****比例勻稱的輪廓****。

Practice 2

> “Well-proportioned” describes relative dimensions rather than an absolute body size.

****well-proportioned**** 描述的是不同部位的****相對比例****，而不是絕對身形大小。

47. ****ill-proportioned — 比例失衡的****

Practice 1

> The extension made the building look ****ill-proportioned****.

擴建部分令建築物看起來****比例失調****。

Practice 2

> An ill-proportioned design may feel visually unbalanced.

****比例不協調的設計****可能在視覺上失去平衡。

P. PROPORTIONS = SCALE / MAGNITUDE

48. ****proportions = size, scale, or extent — 規模；程度****

A major figurative plural use.

Practice 1

> The problem reached enormous **proportions**.

問題發展至**極大規模**。

Practice 2

> The complaint grew to unexpected proportions.

事件擴大至**意想不到的程度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proportions = 某事物發展到的規模、程度或範圍

Usually in phrases like:

> enormous proportions

> epidemic proportions

> gigantic proportions.

49. **of enormous/huge proportions — 規模巨大的**

Practice 1

> The project became an undertaking of enormous proportions.

項目變成一項**規模極大的工程**。

Practice 2

> The problem is not yet of crisis proportions.

問題尚未發展至**危機規模**。

50. **reach epidemic proportions — 達到如疫情般普遍 / 嚴重的程度**

A common figurative expression.

Practice 1

> Return abuse has **not reached epidemic proportions**.

退貨濫用尚未達到**極其普遍嚴重的程度**。

Practice 2

> The phrase “epidemic proportions” is often figurative outside health contexts.

****epidemic proportions**** 在健康以外的語境常是比喻用法，表示問題非常普遍嚴重。

51. ****assume enormous proportions — 擴大至巨大規模****

Formal.

Practice 1

> A small dispute can ****assume enormous proportions**** if poorly handled.

小爭議若處理不當，可能****擴大至非常嚴重的程度****。

Practice 2

> The project gradually assumed larger proportions.

項目的****規模逐漸擴大****。

Q. SENSE OF PROPORTION

52. ****a sense of proportion = ability to judge relative importance realistically — 輕重感；分寸感；比例感****

A major idiom.

Practice 1

> Managers need ****a sense of proportion**** when responding to isolated abuse.

管理人員在處理個別濫用個案時需要有****分寸感 / 輕重判斷****。

Practice 2

> Try to keep a sense of proportion.

要保持****對事情輕重的合理判斷****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sense of proportion = 能夠正確判斷事情真正有多重要或嚴重，而不誇大或輕視****

53. ****lose all sense of proportion — 完全失去分寸 / 誇大事情****

Practice 1

> One bad return should not make us ****lose all sense of proportion****.

不能因為一次不良退貨個案就****完全失去分寸****。

Practice 2

> The argument grew because both sides lost their sense of proportion.

爭論擴大，是因為雙方都****失去了對事情輕重的判斷****。

R. KEEP THINGS IN PROPORTION

54. ****keep something in proportion — 正確看待事情的輕重；不誇大****

Practice 1

> We should ****keep the risk in proportion****.

我們應該****適當看待風險，不要誇大****。

Practice 2

> A few abusive customers must be kept in proportion to the much larger number of genuine customers.

我們應該把少數濫用政策的顧客放回整體背景中****衡量其真正比例和重要性****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****keep X in proportion = 按 X 的真正重要程度看待，不把它誇大或縮小****

55. ****put something into proportion/perspective — 恢復對事情輕重的正確理解****

Practice 1

> The statistics put the abuse problem **into proportion**.

統計數據讓我們能**更準確判斷濫用問題的實際規模**。

Practice 2

> Comparing complaint numbers with total orders puts the issue into proportion.

把投訴數量與總訂單比較，可以讓問題的**實際嚴重程度更清楚**。

S. BLOW SOMETHING OUT OF PROPORTION

56. **blow something out of proportion** — 把事情誇大

A major idiom.

Practice 1

> We should not **blow a few dishonest returns out of proportion**.

我們不應把少數不誠實退貨個案**誇大成嚴重問題**。

Practice 2

> The disagreement was blown out of proportion.

這場分歧被**過分誇大**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blow X out of proportion = 把 X 描述得比實際情況更重要、更嚴重或更大

57. **get something out of proportion** — 對事情的輕重判斷失衡

Practice 1

> Don't **get the problem out of proportion**.

不要**誇大這個問題**。

Practice 2

> Public reaction became completely out of proportion to the incident.

公眾反應相對於事件本身變得**完全過度**。

T. PROPORTION AS A VERB

58. **proportion something = arrange/allocate according to appropriate ratios — 按比例安排 / 分配**

Less common than the noun, but established.

Practice 1

> Ingredients must be carefully **proportioned**.

配料必須仔細**按比例調配**。

Practice 2

> The room was proportioned to create a balanced appearance.

房間各部分尺寸經過**比例設計**，以營造平衡外觀。

MCQ-ready definition:

proportion X = 使 X 的各部分具有特定或合適的比例關係

59. **proportion resources/costs — 按比例分配資源 / 成本**

Formal/less common than **allocate proportionally**.

Practice 1

> Costs were proportioned according to use.

成本按使用量**按比例分配**。

Practice 2

> Modern business English would often prefer “allocated proportionally.”

現代商業英語很多時候會更自然地說 **allocated proportionally**。

U. PROPORTIONED

60. **proportioned** = designed with certain relative dimensions — 按某種比例設計的

Practice 1

> The room is generously **proportioned**.

房間的**空間比例寬敞舒適**。

Practice 2

> The jacket is proportioned for a shorter frame.

這件外套的**剪裁比例**是為較矮身形設計。

61. **generously proportioned** — 尺寸寬敞 / 比例寬大的

Especially architecture/interiors.

Practice 1

> The apartment has **generously proportioned rooms**.

公寓的房間**寬敞、比例舒適**。

Practice 2

> The phrase refers to generous dimensions, not generosity as a personality trait.

這裡的 **generously** 指**尺寸寬裕**，不是性格「慷慨」。

V. DIRECT PROPORTION

62. **direct proportion** — 正比例

A mathematics term.

Practice 1

> If $(y = kx)$, then y is in **direct proportion** to x .

如果 $(y = kx)$, y 與 x **成正比例**。

Practice 2

> Distance is directly proportional to time when speed is constant.

速度固定時，距離與時間**成正比**。

MCQ-ready definition:

direct proportion = 一個量按固定倍數隨另一個量改變的關係

63. **in direct proportion to — 與.....成正比**

Practice 1

> The quantity increases **in direct proportion to** demand.

該數量隨需求**成正比增加**。

Practice 2

> Costs do not always rise in direct proportion to sales.

成本不一定與銷售額**成正比例增加**。

W. INVERSE PROPORTION

64. **inverse proportion — 反比例**

Practice 1

> The variables are in **inverse proportion**.

兩個變量**成反比**。

Practice 2

> In a simple inverse proportion, their product remains constant.

在簡單的**反比例關係**中，兩個量的乘積保持固定。

Important distinction 8: **direct proportion vs positive correlation**

These are **not the same**.

direct proportion

specific mathematical relationship:

> $y = kx$

positive correlation

general tendency:

> when one variable is higher, the other tends to be higher.

A relationship can be positively correlated without being directly proportional.

Important distinction 9: **inverse proportion vs negative correlation**

Likewise:

inverse proportion

specific mathematical form.

negative correlation

general statistical tendency for one to decrease as the other increases.

Do not merge them.

X. PROPORTION vs RATIO

Important distinction 10: **proportion vs ratio**

ratio

explicit comparison between quantities:

> 2:1

proportion

may mean:

1. share of a whole;
2. comparative relationship;
3. equality/correspondence between ratios in mathematics.

Example:

> ratio of exchanges to refunds = 2:1

> proportion of all cases that are exchanges = $\frac{2}{3}$

For learners, keep these concepts distinct.

Important distinction 11: **proportion as a share vs ratio**

If:

- * 20 refunds
- * 80 exchanges
- * 100 total cases

then:

> refund **proportion** = $\frac{20}{100} = 20\%$

but:

> refund-to-exchange **ratio** = $20:80 = 1:4$

Different denominator/reference.

Y. MATHEMATICAL PROPORTION

65. **proportion = equation stating that two ratios are equal — 比例式；比例相等關係**

A specific mathematics sense.

Practice 1

> $\frac{2}{3} = \frac{4}{6}$ forms a **proportion**.

$\frac{2}{3} = \frac{4}{6}$ 構成一個**比例式**。

Practice 2

> Solve the proportion for x.

解這個**比例式**中的 x。

MCQ-ready definition:

proportion = 數學上兩個比率相等的關係 / 等式

66. **solve a proportion — 解比例式**

Practice 1

> Use cross multiplication to solve the proportion.

利用交叉相乘法解這個**比例式**。

Practice 2

> The unknown appears in one term of the proportion.

未知數出現在**比例式**的一項中。

Z. RECIPE / MIXTURE PROPORTIONS

67. **proportions** = amounts relative to one another — 各成分比例

Practice 1

> Mix the ingredients in equal **proportions**.

把配料按**相同比例**混合。

Practice 2

> Changing the proportions changes the texture.

改變配料的**比例**會改變質感。

This is especially natural in:

- * cooking,
- * chemistry,
- * manufacturing,
- * materials.

68. **equal proportions — 等比例 / 等份**

Practice 1

> Mix the two liquids in **equal proportions**.

把兩種液體按**等量比例**混合。

Practice 2

> The budget was not divided in equal proportions.

預算並非按**相同比例**分配。

AA. DESIGN / ART / ARCHITECTURE

69. **proportion = harmonious relationship of dimensions — 比例；均衡感**

Practice 1

> **Proportion** is important in fashion design.

比例在時裝設計中非常重要。

Practice 2

> The designer adjusted the proportions of the sleeves and body.

設計師調整了袖子與衣身的**比例**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****proportion = 設計中不同部分的尺寸關係是否協調****

This is particularly relevant to the fashion passage, even though it is ****not**** the sentence's contextual meaning.

70. ****good proportion — 良好比例****

Practice 1

> The garment has good proportion.

這件服裝的****整體比例協調****。

Practice 2

> Good proportion can change how an outfit looks.

良好的****比例安排****可以改變整套服裝的視覺效果。

71. ****proportion and scale — 比例與尺度****

Common design pairing.

Practice 1

> Designers consider ****proportion and scale****.

設計師會考慮****比例和尺度****。

Practice 2

> Proportion concerns relationships between parts, while scale often concerns size relative to a reference.

****proportion**** 重視各部分彼此的比例，而 ****scale**** 往往重視相對於某基準的尺寸大小。

Important distinction 12: ****proportion vs scale****

****proportion****

relationship among parts.

scale

overall size or size relative to another reference.

A small building and a large building can theoretically have similar proportions but different scale.

Important distinction 13: **proportion vs size**

size

absolute dimensions.

proportion

relative dimensions.

Two people can wear the same clothing size but have different body proportions.

This is highly relevant to your passage's:

> size charts + online fit problem.

Important distinction 14: **proportion vs balance**

balance

overall equilibrium/fair distribution.

proportion

relative amounts/dimensions.

Good proportions often create visual balance, but the words are not identical.

AB. PROPORTIONALITY IN POLICY / REGULATION

72. **proportionality = measure should not go further than justified — 比例性；相稱性**

This deserves its own passage-linked section.

Practice 1

> The proposed pilot improves **proportionality** by distinguishing genuine defects from simple changes of mind.

建議的試行政策透過區分真正缺陷和單純改變主意，提高政策的**比例性 / 相稱性**。

Practice 2

> A blanket ban raises questions of proportionality.

全面禁令會令人質疑其是否**過度 / 合乎比例**。

73. **assess proportionality** — 評估是否合乎比例

Practice 1

> Management should **assess the proportionality** of each safeguard.

管理層應評估每項保障措施是否**合乎比例**。

Practice 2

> The cost, burden and risk should all be considered.

評估比例性時，可考慮**成本、負擔和風險**。

AC. PROPORTIONATE COST / EFFORT

74. **proportionate cost** — 相稱的成本

Practice 1

> The safeguard should achieve its aim at a **proportionate cost**.

保障措施應以**合理相稱的成本**達成目的。

Practice 2

> Full inspection of every low-risk item may not be proportionate in cost.

對每件低風險商品都進行全面檢查，其成本可能**不成比例**。

75. **proportionate effort — 相稱的投入 / 努力**

Practice 1

> Minor cases should require only **proportionate effort**.

輕微個案只應需要**相稱程度的處理工作**。

Practice 2

> Do not spend disproportionate effort on trivial cases.

不要在輕微個案上投入**不成比例的精力**。

AD. PROPORTIONATELY

76. **proportionately = to a corresponding/appropriate degree — 成比例地；相稱地**

Practice 1

> Higher-risk cases should receive **proportionately greater scrutiny**.

風險較高的個案應接受**相應更嚴格的審查**。

Practice 2

> Small errors should be handled proportionately.

輕微錯誤應以**程度相稱的方式**處理。

MCQ-ready definition:

proportionately = 程度按照相關大小、風險或嚴重性作相應調整

AE. DISPROPORTIONAL

77. **disproportional = not proportional — 不成比例的**

This form exists but is considerably less common in ordinary English than:

> **disproportionate**

or, in mathematical contexts:

> **not proportional**.

Practice 1

> The two quantities show a disproportional relationship.

兩個量呈現**非比例關係**。

Practice 2

> For ordinary evaluative English, “disproportionate” is usually the better learner choice.

在一般「過度 / 不相稱」語境中，學習者通常應優先使用 **disproportionate**。

AF. PROPORTION IN STATISTICS

78. **sample proportion — 樣本比例**

A common statistical term.

Practice 1

> The **sample proportion** of customers requesting refunds was 0.12.

樣本中要求退款的顧客**比例**為 0.12。

Practice 2

> The sample proportion estimates a population proportion.

樣本比例可用來估計母體比例。

79. **population proportion — 母體比例**

Practice 1

> Researchers estimated the **population proportion**.

研究人員估計了**母體比例**。

Practice 2

> The true population proportion is generally unknown and estimated from data.

真正的**母體比例**通常未知，需要利用數據估計。

80. **proportion of successes — 成功比例**

Practice 1

> The proportion of approved return requests increased.

獲批退貨申請的**比例**上升。

Practice 2

> Statistical proportions range from 0 to 1.

統計上的**比例**通常以 0 至 1 表示。

Important distinction 15: **proportion vs probability**

proportion

observed/defined share in a group.

probability

likelihood of an event.

An observed proportion may be used to estimate a probability, but they are conceptually different.

AG. PROPORTION IN FINANCE / BUSINESS DATA

81. **proportion of revenue/cost/sales — 收入 / 成本 / 銷售的佔比**

Practice 1

> Returns account for a small **proportion of total sales**.

退貨只佔總銷售的很小**比例**。

Practice 2

> Delivery costs represent a growing proportion of expenses.

送貨成本佔總開支的**比例正在上升**。

82. **proportion accounted for by X — X 所佔比例**

Practice 1

> What proportion of complaints is accounted for by sizing problems?

尺碼問題佔投訴的**多少比例**？

Practice 2

> Defects account for only a small proportion.

產品缺陷只佔**小部分**。

AH. "IN PROPORTION" WITHOUT A FOLLOWING NOUN

83. **in proportion = in a balanced/reasonable relationship — 比例協調；程度合理**

Practice 1

> The sleeves look slightly too long, but the rest of the garment is **in proportion**.

袖子看來稍長，但衣服其他部分的**比例仍然協調**。

Practice 2

> Costs and benefits should remain broadly in proportion.

成本和效益應保持大致**相稱**。

84. **out of proportion = disproportionate / exaggerated — 失去比例；過度**

Practice 1

> The sleeves look **out of proportion** to the body of the blouse.

袖子相對於襯衫衣身看來**比例失調**。

Practice 2

> The reaction was out of proportion.

反應**過度了**。

Same expression can therefore be:

* physical/design,

* figurative/evaluative.

AI. "PROPORTION" AND CLOTHING/FASHION

The passage is about online fashion, so this branch is especially pedagogically useful.

85. **garment proportions — 服裝比例**

Practice 1

> The jacket's **proportions** did not suit her body shape.

外套的**剪裁比例**不適合她的身形。

Practice 2

> Sleeve length can affect the visual proportions of a garment.

袖長可以影響衣服的**整體視覺比例**。

86. **proportioned for a body type — 按某身形比例設計**

Practice 1

> Petite clothing is ****proportioned for shorter frames****.

嬌小尺寸服裝會按較矮身形的****身體比例設計****。

Practice 2

> The same waist measurement does not mean the same overall proportions.

腰圍相同並不表示整體****身形比例****相同。

This reinforces why:

> size chart ≠ perfect fit.

Important distinction 16: ****proportion vs fit****

****fit****

how well clothing matches a person's actual body dimensions/shape.

****proportion****

relationship between dimensions/parts.

A garment can technically fit at the waist but look poorly proportioned in:

- * sleeve length,
- * torso length,
- * leg length.

Very relevant to the passage.

AJ. PROPORTIONATE VS REASONABLE

Important distinction 17: ****proportionate vs reasonable****

****reasonable****

generally sensible/fair.

****proportionate****

specifically appropriately matched in degree to:

- * risk,
- * harm,
- * purpose,
- * seriousness.

> reasonable policy

> broad judgment

> proportionate restriction

> specific relation between restriction and problem.

Important distinction 18: **proportionate vs appropriate**

appropriate

suitable for context.

proportionate

suitable **in magnitude/severity** relative to another factor.

A policy may be inappropriate because:

- * wording is confusing,
- * timing is bad,
- * target group is wrong.

It is disproportionate specifically because:

> it goes too far or not far enough relative to the problem.

Important distinction 19: **proportionate vs fair**

As above:

> fair = just treatment

> proportionate = degree not excessive/insufficient.

A penalty might be proportionate in severity but still unfair if applied selectively.

Important distinction 20: **proportionate vs balanced**

balanced

takes competing considerations into account.

proportionate

ensures the burden/restriction corresponds appropriately to the risk or objective.

Your proposal aims for both.

Important distinction 21: **proportionate vs moderate**

moderate

not extreme.

proportionate

may actually be severe if the underlying risk is severe.

Example:

> serious fraud may justify a strict but proportionate response.

So:

proportionate ≠ always lenient.

Important distinction 22: **proportionate vs equal**

equal

same amount.

proportionate

amount varies according to a relevant basis.

Example:

If departments have different sales volumes:

> equal cost split

> = each pays same amount

> proportional cost split

> = each pays according to its share.

Important distinction 23: **proportional vs equal**

Same principle:

> 50/50 = equal

but:

> 70/30 based on sales shares

can be perfectly **proportional** even though it is unequal.

AK. PROPORTION VS SHARE

Important distinction 24: **proportion vs share**

They overlap strongly.

share

the actual part belonging/contributed to someone/category.

proportion

emphasizes that part relative to the whole.

> our share of sales

> 我們的銷售份額

> the proportion of sales from online customers

> 網購顧客所佔銷售比例

Important distinction 25: **proportion vs fraction**

fraction

literally a numerical fraction or informally a small part.

proportion

neutral relative share.

> a fraction of customers

> often suggests **very few**

> a proportion of customers

> neutral; can be large or small.

Important distinction 26: **proportion vs percentage point**

If a return rate rises:

> from 10% to 15%

then:

* increase = **5 percentage points**

* relative proportional increase = **50%**

This is a useful quantitative distinction, even though **percentage point** belongs outside the word family.

AL. DISPROPORTIONATE VS UNFAIR

Important distinction 27: **disproportionate vs unfair**

disproportionate

too much/little relative to the relevant problem.

unfair

broader injustice.

Example:

> banning a customer permanently for one innocent sizing return

> could be both:

* disproportionate,

* unfair.

But the words explain different problems.

Important distinction 28: **disproportionate vs excessive**

excessive

too much in absolute/general terms.

disproportionate

too much **relative to something else**.

> excessive fee

> too high generally

> disproportionate fee

> too high compared with:

* service,

* risk,

* loss,

* transaction value.

Important distinction 29: **disproportionate vs unequal**

unequal

not the same.

disproportionate

difference lacks the appropriate relationship.

Unequal treatment may be proportionate when relevant circumstances differ.

AM. PROPORTIONALITY IN YOUR PASSAGE

The sentence is:

> At issue is not whether customers should be allowed to change their minds without limit, but whether our present rule is **proportionate** for online fashion.

Chris is deliberately rejecting two extremes:

Extreme 1

> unlimited returns

Extreme 2

> absolutely no exchange / no refund

He proposes:

middle position

> limited returns + evidence + inspection + category restrictions + return limits + abuse safeguards.

That is exactly what **proportionate policy design** means here:

The restriction should be no stronger than necessary to protect the business from genuine abuse while still giving honest customers a fair remedy.

Important distinction 30: **“proportionate for online fashion” vs “proportionate to...”**

The passage says:

> **proportionate for online fashion**

The intended meaning is clear:

> suitable and not excessively restrictive **in the context of online fashion**.

However, the most canonical collocation for ****proportionate**** is often:

> ****proportionate to + risk/problem/need/seriousness****

For example:

> Is the rule ****proportionate to the risk of return abuse?****

or:

> Is the restriction ****proportionate to the problem it is designed to prevent?****

So learners should strongly remember:

****proportionate to X****

while recognizing the passage's:

> ****proportionate for this context****

as "appropriate in degree for this situation."

Important distinction 31: ****proportionate policy vs blanket ban****

Later the letter proposes replacing:

> the ****blanket ban****

with conditional rules.

Why?

Because a blanket ban treats all situations alike:

- * defective zip,
- * wrong colour,
- * misleading size chart,
- * simple change of mind,
- * deliberate wardrobe rental.

A proportionate policy differentiates according to:

****cause + seriousness + evidence + abuse risk****

That is a central argumentative idea in the whole letter.

Important distinction 32: **proportionality vs safeguards**

Safeguards themselves should also be proportionate.

For example:

- > requiring an order number
- > low burden → proportionate

- > inspecting high-risk items
- > moderate burden → potentially proportionate

- > permanently banning every customer after one size exchange
- > very high burden → potentially disproportionate

So proportionality applies both to:

- * customer rights,
- * anti-abuse controls.

Family-extension note

The **proportion** family has several major modern branches:

1. **part of a whole**

- * a proportion of customers
- * large/small proportion

2. **relationship between quantities**

- * correct proportions
- * relative proportions

3. **appropriate relation**

- * in proportion to
- * out of proportion to

4. **policy/legal appropriateness**

- * proportionate response
- * proportionate restriction

5. **quantitative correspondence**

- * proportional to
- * proportionally

6. **mathematics**

- * direct proportion
- * inverse proportion
- * mathematical proportion

7. **allocation**

- * proportional share
- * proportional allocation

8. **electoral terminology**

- * proportional representation

9. **proportionality**

- * quantitative relationship
- * legal/regulatory proportionality

10. **opposite**

- * disproportionate
- * disproportionately

11. **physical dimensions**

- * body proportions
- * architectural proportions

12. **balanced design**

- * well-proportioned
- * ill-proportioned

13. **large scale**

- * enormous proportions
- * epidemic proportions

14. **judgment of importance**

- * sense of proportion
- * keep things in proportion

15. **exaggeration**

- * blow out of proportion

16. **verb**

- * proportion ingredients
- * proportion a design

17. **statistics**

- * sample proportion
- * population proportion

18. **fashion/design**

- * garment proportions
- * proportioned for a body type

For your passage, the exact branch is:

proportionate = appropriately limited in severity and scope relative to the actual risk and circumstances

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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proportion (share)	比例；部分	part of whole	
a proportion of X	X 的一部分 / 比例	share	
large proportion	大比例	share	
small proportion	小比例	share	
significant proportion	相當大比例	share	
growing proportion	日益增加的比例	trend	
proportion who...	的人所佔比例	statistics	
proportion (relationship)	比例關係	relative amounts	

correct proportions	正確比例	mixture/design	
relative proportions	相對比例	comparison	
in proportion to	與.....成比例 / 相稱	correspondence	
out of proportion to	與.....不成比例	mismatch	
proportionate	相稱的；合乎比例的	passage sense	
proportionate to risk	與風險相稱	risk	
proportionate response	適度 / 相稱回應	policy	
proportionate measure	相稱措施	policy	
proportionate penalty	相稱處罰	penalty	
proportionately	相稱地；按比例地	adverb	
proportional	成比例的	quantitative	
proportional to	與.....成比例	mathematics/general	
directly proportional	成正比	mathematics	
inversely proportional	成反比	mathematics	
proportional increase	按比例增加	quantitative	
proportional share	比例份額	allocation	
proportional allocation	按比例分配	allocation	
proportional representation	比例代表制	elections	
proportionality	比例關係 / 相稱性	noun	
principle of proportionality	比例原則	law/policy	
proportionality test	比例性審查	law	
disproportionate	不成比例 / 過度的	opposite	
disproportionate response	過度回應	policy	
disproportionate impact	不成比例的影響	impact	
disproportionate burden	過重負擔	burden	
disproportionate cost	不成比例成本	cost	
disproportionately	不成比例地	adverb	
disproportionately high	高得不成比例	degree	
proportions (dimensions)	各部分比例	physical dimensions	
body proportions	身體比例	fashion/body	
human proportions	人體比例	art/anatomy	
architectural proportions	建築比例	design	
well-proportioned	比例勻稱的	balanced dimensions	
ill-proportioned	比例失調的	unbalanced	
proportions (scale)	規模；程度	magnitude	
enormous proportions	巨大規模	magnitude	
epidemic proportions	極其普遍嚴重的程度	magnitude	
sense of proportion	分寸感；輕重判斷	judgment	
keep X in proportion	適當看待 X	perspective	
blow X out of proportion	誇大 X	exaggeration	
proportion (verb)	按比例安排	adjustment	
proportioned	按比例設計的	dimensions	
generously proportioned	尺寸寬敞的	architecture	
direct proportion	正比例	mathematics	
inverse proportion	反比例	mathematics	
proportion (ratio equality)	比例式	mathematics	

equal proportions	等比例 / 等份	mixture	
sample proportion	樣本比例	statistics	
population proportion	母體比例	statistics	
garment proportions	服裝比例	fashion	

For your original sentence

> At issue is not whether customers should be allowed to change their minds without limit, but whether our present rule is ****proportionate**** for online fashion.

Here:

****proportionate = 現行「不設換貨 / 退款」規則的嚴格程度，是否與公司真正需要防範的風險和網購顧客面對的不確定性合理相稱，而沒有嚴厲過頭****

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 真正需要討論的，不是應否讓顧客毫無限制地改變主意，而是我們現行的規定對網上時裝購物而言是否****合乎比例、是否過於嚴苛****。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

- > ****proportion**** = 整體中所佔的****比例 / 部分****
- > ****ratio**** = 兩個數量之間的****比****
- > ****percentage**** = 以 100 為基準表示的****百分比****
- > ****proportional**** = ****數量上成比例的****
- > ****proportionate**** = ****程度上相稱、不過度的****
- > ****disproportionate**** = ****相對於問題 / 風險而言過度或不足的****
- > ****reasonable**** = 廣義合理
- > ****fair**** = 公平
- > ****balanced**** = 兼顧不同因素
- > ****appropriate**** = 適合情況

And for this passage, the most important contrast is:

- > ****proportional**** → “數字是否按比例變化？”
- > ****proportionate**** → ****“這個限制是不是比真正需要的更嚴？”****

That second question is exactly what Chris is asking about the no-exchange/no-refund rule.